App And Connectivity

Phone Key Setup

To use your smartphone as a key, ensure your phone meets the minimum requirements: iPhone 8 or later with iOS 15.0 or later, or Android 10 or later with Bluetooth 5.0 and NFC support. Open the Tesla app and go to Controls > Phone Key. Tap "Set Up Phone Key" and follow the prompts. The setup takes less than 2 minutes. Once enabled, your phone will automatically unlock the vehicle when you're within 15 feet. For added security, the phone key requires your device to be unlocked and within 10 feet of the car to start driving. You can manage multiple phone keys from the app. If you replace your phone, re-enable the key on the new device within 15 minutes of the old one being removed to avoid lockout.

Bluetooth Pairing

Bluetooth pairing is automatic when you approach your vehicle with a paired phone. If pairing fails, go to the car’s touchscreen Controls > Bluetooth and select "Add Device." Your phone should appear within 30 seconds. Once paired, audio and calls will stream through the car’s speakers. The system remembers up to 8 devices. If you experience audio dropouts, ensure your phone is not in power-saving mode and restart Bluetooth on both devices. Re-pairing takes under 1 minute and is recommended every 6 months to maintain connection stability.

Wi-Fi and Cellular Connection

Your vehicle connects to Wi-Fi automatically when within 30 feet of a saved network. To add a new network, go to Controls > Wi-Fi > Add Network. Enter the password using the touchscreen keyboard. The connection process takes approximately 45 seconds. For cellular connectivity, your car uses a built-in SIM card with a 4G LTE connection. The signal strength is displayed in the status bar. If connectivity drops, check the antenna icon on the touchscreen. A weak signal may occur in tunnels or remote areas. The system attempts to reconnect every 2 minutes. In rare cases, a manual reset via Controls > System > Restart can restore connection within 90 seconds.

Software Updates

Over-the-air updates are delivered automatically when your car is plugged in and parked. Updates are typically 1.2 GB to 2.8 GB in size and take 15 to 30 minutes to install. The car will notify you 24 hours in advance. During installation, the vehicle remains in a safe state and does not allow driving. After the update completes, the car restarts and may take up to 3 minutes to return to full functionality. You can check update status in the app under Controls > Software. Updates are released every 4 to 6 weeks and include performance improvements, new features, and safety enhancements. The latest version is always installed within 72 hours of release.

Premium Connectivity

Premium Connectivity is included for the first 3 years after purchase and extends the vehicle’s internet capabilities. It enables real-time traffic routing, remote software updates, and access to the full suite of Tesla services. After the initial period, the subscription costs $10 per month or $100 per year. To activate, go to Controls > Premium Connectivity in the touchscreen. You can cancel at any time. With

Premium Connectivity, your car maintains a consistent 4G LTE connection, allowing features like live video streaming and remote diagnostics. The system uses data at a rate of approximately 120 MB per hour during continuous navigation. If you travel outside the U.S., the service may be limited to 150 MB per month unless you purchase an international add-on. The app displays data usage in real time under Controls > Premium Connectivity.